

Colorado Springs School District 11

Community Baseline Survey

Topline Results

Prepared for: Colorado Springs School District 11

Prepared by: Fog Signal Strategies

March 2026

Methodology

This survey was conducted by Fog Signal Strategies on behalf of Colorado Springs School District 11 between February and March 2026. The survey was administered via text-to-web and phone among 852 registered voters in the District 11 boundary who have a history of voting in midterm general elections (voted in either the 2022 or 2018 general election). The survey instrument consisted of approximately 50 questions and took an average of 12 minutes to complete.

The sample of n=852 yields a margin of error of approximately $\pm 3.4\%$ at the 95% confidence level for the full sample. Margins of error for subgroups will be wider. Post-stratification weights were applied by age group to align the sample with the midterm likely voter universe demographics.

Results are reported as percentages. Due to rounding, percentages may not sum to exactly 100%.

Section 1: Community Issue Importance

Respondents were asked to rate the importance of various community issues on a four-point scale. Issues are ranked by combined "Extremely" and "Very Important" responses. (n=852)

Issue	Extremely Important	Very Important	Combined Imp.	Not At All Important
Making sure schools are safe and secure for students	67.1%	23.9%	91.1%	1.5%
Improving the quality of education in local public s...	64.5%	26.0%	90.6%	2.9%
Maintaining local streets and roads	46.4%	42.6%	89.0%	1.1%
Improving the overall performance of Colorado Spring...	46.4%	34.5%	81.0%	3.6%
Reducing crime and gang activity	51.8%	26.5%	78.3%	4.7%
Repairing and upgrading aging school facilities	34.7%	39.0%	73.7%	3.2%
Managing growth and new development	36.1%	35.8%	71.9%	5.4%
Addressing homelessness	38.3%	33.5%	71.8%	4.0%
Attracting businesses and good-paying jobs	28.9%	41.1%	70.0%	5.5%
Improving local parks and recreation	25.4%	36.7%	62.1%	4.0%
Preventing local tax increases	31.0%	19.1%	50.2%	18.1%

Key Finding: Making sure schools are safe and secure for students (91.1%) and improving the quality of education in local public schools (90.6%) top community concerns, closely followed by maintaining local streets and roads (89.0%). Preventing local tax increases ranks at 50.2%, indicating a notable tax-sensitive segment of the electorate.

Section 2: Quality of Education in District 11

Respondents were asked to rate the overall quality of education in Colorado Springs School District 11. (n=852)

Rating	Percent
Excellent	6.0%
Good	33.3%
Fair	29.1%
Poor	9.2%
Very Poor	6.2%
Not Sure	16.2%
NET Positive (Excellent + Good)	39.3%
NET Negative (Poor + Very Poor)	15.4%

Key Finding: Only 39.3% rate education quality positively, while 15.4% rate it negatively. A notable 16.2% are unsure, and the plurality rating is "Good" at 33.3%. The "Fair" category at 29.1% represents a large persuadable middle.

Section 3: Bond Measure Ballot Tests

The survey tested voter support for the proposed \$750 million school bond at three points: an initial ballot, after hearing support arguments, and a final ballot after hearing both support and opposition arguments. (n=852)

Response	Initial Ballot	After Support Arguments	Final Ballot
Definitely Yes	31.0%	30.6%	25.8%
Probably Yes	27.5%	27.9%	25.7%
TOTAL YES	58.5%	58.6%	51.5%
Not Sure	10.2%	9.9%	10.9%
Probably No	14.4%	14.3%	17.0%
Definitely No	16.9%	17.2%	20.5%
TOTAL NO	31.3%	31.6%	37.6%

Key Finding: The bond measure starts with majority support at 58.5% Yes but erodes to 51.5% Yes after voters hear opposition arguments — a 7.0-point decline. Support arguments have minimal impact on the overall number, while opposition arguments move the needle significantly. The "Definitely Yes" vote drops from 31.0% to 25.8%, indicating soft support vulnerable to opposition messaging.

Section 4: Vote Movement Analysis

Among the 852 respondents who completed all three ballot tests, the following table shows how initial votes translated to final votes after exposure to both support and opposition arguments.

Initial Vote →	Final: Yes	Final: Undecided	Final: No
Started Yes	369 (74.1%)	46 (9.2%)	83 (16.7%)
Started Undecided	29 (33.3%)	29 (33.3%)	29 (33.3%)
Started No	41 (15.4%)	18 (6.7%)	209 (77.9%)

Key Finding: 74.1% of initial Yes voters held firm, but 26% softened to Undecided or flipped to No. Among initial Undecided voters, 33.3% moved to Yes — a positive sign. However, No voters are highly locked in at 77.9% retention. The primary campaign challenge is hardening soft Yes voters against opposition messaging.

Section 5: Bond Fund Uses

Respondents were asked to rate their level of support for potential uses of bond funds. Items are ranked by total favor. (n=852)

Bond Use	Strongly Favor	Somewhat Favor	Total Favor	Total Oppose	Not Sure
Improving heating, ventilation, air conditioning...	47.9%	34.5%	82.5%	11.2%	6.2%
Upgrading older schools to meet health codes, b...	57.6%	24.5%	82.2%	11.6%	6.2%
Repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, plu...	54.7%	26.9%	81.7%	10.9%	7.4%
Removing hazardous materials like asbestos and ...	57.1%	22.8%	80.0%	11.7%	8.2%
Improving student safety and campus security sy...	47.9%	31.5%	79.5%	13.8%	6.7%
Providing modern labs and equipment for college...	44.0%	34.4%	78.5%	14.4%	7.0%
Providing classrooms and facilities for music, ...	45.0%	31.7%	76.7%	16.4%	6.8%
Modernizing classrooms, facilities, and technol...	38.9%	37.1%	76.0%	17.2%	6.7%
Creating modern, multi-use classrooms for hands...	38.8%	35.6%	74.4%	16.5%	9.0%
Replacing aging portable classrooms with modern...	38.1%	35.9%	74.0%	16.0%	9.8%
Upgrading and repairing physical education faci...	25.4%	45.2%	70.7%	22.2%	7.0%
Building or renovating school facilities to sup...	31.6%	36.1%	67.7%	20.4%	11.8%
Resurfacing and repairing school parking lots t...	16.3%	45.2%	61.5%	29.5%	8.9%

Key Finding: Improving heating, ventilation, air conditioning, and air qu (82.5%), upgrading older schools to meet health codes, building safet (82.2%), and repairing or replacing deteriorating roofs, plumbing, heatin (81.7%) receive the strongest support. Resurfacing and repairing school parking lots to improve parent and student parking (61.5%) receives the least support. Health, safety, and building infrastructure items consistently outperform other categories.

Section 6: Support Argument Testing

Respondents were read a series of arguments in favor of the bond measure and asked how convincing each was. Arguments are ranked by total convincing. (n=852)

1. *“Student safety has become a top priority. This bond will fund increased safety and security measures to protect students and staff.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
27.8%	39.5%	67.3%	26.8%

2. *“The bond will fund career and technical education, and prepare students for careers in healthcare, engineering, skilled trades, and technology.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
30.0%	36.8%	66.9%	27.5%

3. *“Aging school buildings waste energy and cost more to maintain. By upgrading facilities, this bond will save money on operating costs in the long run.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
27.8%	38.7%	66.5%	29.4%

4. *“This measure will help fix and modernize aging school facilities across the district, giving all students access to 21st-century learning environments.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
26.5%	39.9%	66.4%	28.7%

5. *“Local businesses and employers need a skilled workforce. By preparing students for careers, this measure benefits the entire regional economy.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
29.2%	36.2%	65.4%	28.3%

6. *“All money raised by the measure will stay local to support our students. It can't be taken away by the State or used for other purposes.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
35.8%	29.5%	65.3%	29.9%

7. *“Colorado Springs District 11 hasn't asked voters to pass a school bond in over 20 years. This measure is long overdue to address critical facility needs.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
34.0%	31.3%	65.3%	28.7%

8. *“Voters are protected because the bond cannot be used for administrator salaries or operating expenses – only for facility construction and improvements.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
32.7%	31.5%	64.2%	30.6%

9. *“Without this investment, our schools will fall further behind, making it harder to attract and retain quality teachers and students.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
27.5%	32.8%	60.4%	33.5%

10. *“This measure will help right-size the district, reducing operating costs and improving educational quality by consolidating schools into modern facilities.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
20.6%	34.3%	54.9%	37.7%

11. *“School District 11 has a fiscally responsible plan for using bond funds, with strict financial accountability and independent audits.”*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
21.7%	33.1%	54.7%	39.4%

Key Finding: The strongest support arguments cluster in a narrow range (54.7% to 67.3% total convincing). Student safety (67.3%) and career/technical education (66.9%) lead, while the fiscally responsible plan argument (54.7%) and right-sizing the district (54.9%) are weakest. No support argument exceeds 67% total convincing, indicating a ceiling on persuasive impact.

Section 7: Opposition Argument Testing

Respondents were read a series of arguments against the bond measure and asked how convincing each was. Arguments are ranked by total convincing. (n=852)

1. *"The school board has not been transparent about long-term plans for school closures and consolidations. Voters should not approve this bond until there is a clear plan."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
42.8%	33.4%	76.2%	15.2%

2. *"District 11 already has a history of financial mismanagement. Before asking voters for \$750 million, the district should prove it can manage existing funds responsibly."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
44.3%	29.8%	74.1%	20.5%

3. *"There is no legally binding guarantee that bond funds will be spent as promised. The project list can change after voters approve the measure."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
43.5%	29.3%	72.8%	18.4%

4. *"This bond measure will increase property taxes by \$55 million per year. Working families, seniors on fixed incomes, and small businesses simply can't afford this tax increase."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
40.3%	32.4%	72.8%	21.9%

5. *"Residents and businesses have been hit hard by inflation, high interest rates, and high gas prices. Now is not the time to raise taxes."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
36.2%	34.3%	70.5%	25.6%

6. *"School enrollment in District 11 has been declining. The district should right-size itself and reduce expenses rather than asking for money to build more facilities."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
28.6%	36.1%	64.7%	28.3%

7. *"A \$750 million bond will cost taxpayers over \$1.3 billion once interest is included. That's too high a price for facilities upgrades that could be funded more affordably."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
35.5%	29.2%	64.7%	27.7%

8. *"The district has not made a convincing case that all of the proposed projects are truly necessary or represent the best use of taxpayer money."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
28.7%	33.2%	61.9%	29.0%

9. *"With so many competing needs in our community, spending \$750 million on school buildings is not the highest priority right now."*

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
21.6%	28.0%	49.6%	43.1%

10. “Private and charter schools have shown they can educate students more cost-effectively. We should redirect education funding to alternatives rather than prop up an expensive district bureaucracy.”

Very Convincing	Somewhat Convincing	Total Convincing	Not Convincing
29.1%	18.5%	47.6%	47.6%

Key Finding: Opposition arguments are significantly stronger than support arguments. Board transparency (76.2%), financial mismanagement history (74.1%), and no legally binding guarantee (72.8%) are the most potent attacks. The top 5 opposition messages all exceed 70% total convincing, compared to the top support argument at only 67.3%. The campaign must proactively address trust and accountability concerns to protect the Yes vote.

Section 8: Respondent Connection to District 11

Respondents were asked about their personal connection to District 11 schools.

Question	Yes	No
Currently have children in D11 schools	21.2%	78.8%
Children attend private/charter schools	6.4%	93.6%
Children previously attended D11 schools	48.5%	51.5%

Key Finding: Only 21.2% of respondents currently have children in D11 schools, while 48.5% had children who previously attended. The majority of voters being asked to approve the bond do not have a direct current stake in the schools, reinforcing the importance of community-benefit messaging rather than parent-focused appeals.